

Just for Kicks

A pair of sneakers is functional and comfortable.
Here are some that could also turn heads

BY ABHIK SEN

Shoes maketh the man' goes an old saying. If you must make a statement, a pair of shoes seems the perfect fit. And there are some crazy things happening in 'sneakerland' lately. Take, for instance, a shoe filled with actual beer! Heineken recently came out with a pair of limited-edition sneakers called Heinekicks, which had Heineken Silver beer filled in its soles. "Beer for your

sole" it said of the collaboration with shoe designer Dominic Ciambrone. Luxury brand Balenciaga, too, kicked up a storm online when it released the distressed version of its Paris High Top Sneakers. Featuring "fully destroyed" details like rips and scuffs, it retailed for \$1,850. While you may dismiss these as gimmicks, for a serious sneakerhead, here are a few pairs essential for your wardrobe.



LOUIS VUITTON AND NIKE 'AIR FORCE 1' BY VIRGIL ABLOH

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► **Virgil Abloh**, the late men's art director for the luxury fashion brand, had created 47 bespoke editions of the Louis Vuitton and Nike 'Air Force 1's for his Louis Vuitton Spring-Summer 2022 collection presented in June 2021. Of these, nine editions were released to stores at €2,500 for mid-tops and €2,000 for low-tops. Featuring Abloh's distinct style, the Italy-made shoes are crafted out of the finest leather and materials. Among the shoes available in stores is the classic all-white sneaker embossed with the LV logo; two-tone editions in white with green, red or blue detailing; a metallic gold sneaker; and a Damier edition. Go ahead and gift yourself a piece of history from this posthumous collection.